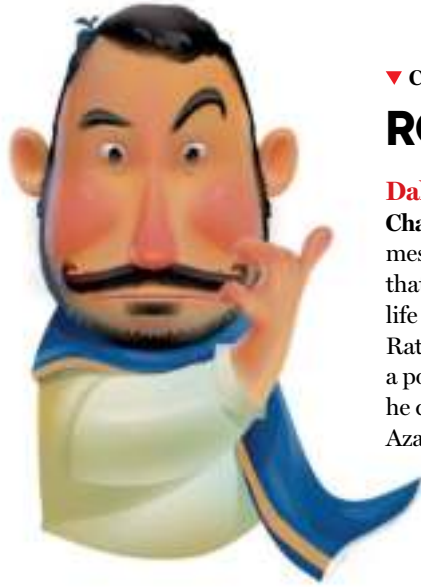
▼ GLASSHOUSE



SAME OLD, SAME OLD

The 'old politician is dead', bring on the new politics of love, dialogue and democratic space, Rahul Gandhi had declared at his party's Bharat Summit in Hyderabad. But walking the talk? That has seldom been Congress's strong suit. And so AICC Telangana in-charge Meenakshi Natarajan recently decreed that district and mandal leaders be appointed next month, but with a caveat—they must include only those loyal since 2017. Many a recent entrant owes their rise to CM Revanth Reddy, who led the party to victory in Telangana not so long ago. Ergo, the clipped wings.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**



▼ CASTE ASIDE

ROLLING IN STYLE

Dalit leader and Lok Sabha MP **Chandra Shekhar Azad** may be a messiah of the downtrodden, but that doesn't cancel out living the high life occasionally. Nothing on the sly. Rather, the 38-year-old neta made a point of feting it with an Insta reel he dropped. On a recent US trip, the Azad Samaj Party honcho is seen burning rubber around Indiana in a white Rolls-Royce, the beats of KGF firing up the background. The number plate: 'CHAMAR3'. Netizens were split. Some saw it as a proud flex for marginalised communities, others balked at the ostentation, yet others saw caste disdain in that reaction. CSA is sure cruising into the spotlight.